DE MISSIONIBUS CATHOLICIS TERRAE SANCTAE IUVANDIS

Benedict XV · Latin

MOTU PROPRIO

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Nuper ex Venerabilis Fratris Patriarchae Hierosolymitani l i t t e r i s c o g n o v i m u s P a l e s t i n e n s e s Missiones e x d i r e p t i o n e q u a m p a s s a e s u n t , a d e o d e b i l i t a t a s iacere, u t i a m n e q u e a n t q u a e s i t u s d i u t i n i s l a b o r i b u s r e t i n e r e fructus, n e d u m proficere posse v i - d e a n t u r . A d h a e c a l i u d accedere i d e m q u e p r a e c i p u u m i n c o m - m o d u m d e p l o r a m u s : a d v e n a s acatholicos e a m i s e r a c o n d i t i o n e r e r u m abuti ad s u a s inibi d o c t r i n a s disseminandas ; idque, u t p o t e o p i b u s copiisque affluentes, efficere vel i n c o l a r u m egestati s u b v e n i e n d o , vel, e t m a x i m e , scholas i n s t i t u e n d o in iis q u o q u e locis u b i n o s t r i s u a d a m n a s a r c i r e n o n p o s s i n t . Intelligitis, Venerabiles Fratres, quid in hac re ab homini b u s catholicis a n i m a r u m s a l u s , q u i d i p s a T e r r a e S a n c t a e r a - tio p o s t u l e t . U t e n i m i n Allocutione, q u a m h e s t e r n a d i e in Con- sistorio h a b u i m u s , d i c e b a m u s , o m n i n o n o n f e r e n d u m est ibi t o t a n i m a s , a c a t h o l i c a fide deficiendo, r u e r e in i n t e r i t u m , u b i I e s u s C h r i s t u s D o m i n u s Noster v i t a m a e t e r n a m eis profuso s a n g u i n e acquisivit. O m n e s i g i t u r boni, q u a c u m q u e o p e p o s s u n t , h i s Mis- s i o n i b u s a u x i l i e n t u r o p o r t e t u t e l i d e n d i s a c a t h o l i c o r u m 'colla- tis e v a d a n t p a r e s . Nos c e r t a m s u m m a m h u i c rei d e s t i n a v i m u s , a m p l i u s l i b e n t e r d a t u r i , nisi A p o s t o l i c a e Sedis a n g u s t i i s p r o - h i b e r e m u r . Quod a u t e m a d v o s a t t i n e t , h o r t a t i o n e N o s t r a p r o -

f e c t o n o n i n d i g e t i s , u t e a r u m d e m M i s s i o n u m c a u s a m a g e r e a p u d vestros populos omni studio nitamini. Vobis vero instantibus p l u r i m o s c o n f i d i m u s esse r e s p o n s u r o s , s a l v a t a m e n s t i p e q u a e , s e c u n d u m Decessoris N o s t r i fel. rec. L e o n i s X I I I l i t t e r a s Salva- toris ac Domini, p r o Locis S a n c t i s est o o r r o g a n d a et ad Custo- dem Terrae Sanctae transmittenda. Auspicem caelestium m u n e r u m benevolentiaeque Nostrae t e s t e m , vobis, V e n e r a b i l e s F r a t r e s , et Clero p o p u l o q u e v e s t r o apostolicam benedictionem peramanter impertimus. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d s a n c t u m P e t r u m , die x i m a r t i i , a n n o mcmxix, Pontificatus Nostri quinto.

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